

Avni as now we have the additional capacity to meet the rising demand for LED lighting products across various segments. We are optimistic that this acquisition would boost MIC's market shares in this segment."

IFCI invests in renewable energy

IFCI Venture Capital will invest Rs 300 million in Titan Energy Systems Limited—a Hyderabad-based maker of solar photovoltaic (PV) modules and engineering procurement and consultancy service provider. The joint venture will set up two grid-connected solar PV power plants of 3MW capacity in Yalsendra (Karnataka) and 1.5MW capacity in Jamuria (West Bengal) on turnkey basis.

Nayar is vice-chairman of HCL Technologies

HCL Technologies has promoted its CEO Vineet Nayar to the position of vice-chairman. Passion and innovation have been key drivers of Nayar. According to him, "We undervalue human values, we under expect from them and we tend to under invest in them. In fact, they are the core difference."

HCL Infosystems appoints CEO

HCL Infosystems has appointed Harsh Chitale as chief executive officer. Based in Noida, Chitale will take over the baton of CEO from Ajai Chowdhry who will continue to be the chairman of the company.

Chitale moves to HCL Infosystems from Honeywell Process Solutions—a wholly-owned subsidiary of Honeywell

International—where he led the business for the North and South America region.

Apotheker is new HP CEO

Hewlett Packard has roped in former SAP head Leo Apotheker as its new chief executive and president. Earlier this year, Apotheker had resigned from SAP amid employee discontent about his cutting of some 3000 jobs—SAP's first-ever major round of layoffs.

Ghosh quits ViewSonic

Gautam Ghosh has resigned as the country manager of ViewSonic India after nearly five years of stint at the visual display products company. Based out of Delhi, Ghosh had been spearheading India operations of ViewSonic since February 2006 and was the most visible face of the company in India.

Snippets

Smartphone sales surging

According to Florian Seiche, head of HTC EMEA (Europe, Middle East, Africa), "Seventy to eighty per cent of all mobile phones shipped next year are expected to be smartphones." With customers upgrading their mobile phones and first-time users increasingly reaching for premium handsets, the high-end segment will continue to be very strong.

Cellphones to penetrate 97 per cent of India's population by 2014

According to iSuppli, cellphone ownership in India is expected to reach 97 per cent of the country's 1.26 billion population. With about 19 million new subscribers being added every month, India's total wireless subscriptions are likely to reach 766 million—45.9 per cent higher than 525 million subscribers counted at the end of 2009.

Mirc Electronics to enter LED lighting business

Mirc Electronics, the manufacturer of Onida TV, is planning to enter the LED lighting business—a relatively nascent market in India. It will start operations in three months.

AEG Power plans solar PV projects in India

AEG Power Solutions, a Europe-based power electronics company, has partnered with Electrotherm, an Indian solar developer, to deploy 100 MW of solar photovoltaic (PV) projects across India in the next three years. The first installations will be done in Gujarat and Rajasthan.

Bergamo too to set up solar power plant in India

Bergamo Acquisition, a US-based firm, will set up a mega solar thermal power plant, with an investment of \$400 million, near Baddi industrial area in Solan district of Himachal Pradesh. "Initially, the company is going to install a 100MW solar thermal plant in the Baddi-Barotiwala area," said Hillard Herzog, president and chief executive officer, Bergamo Acquisition.

Huawei manufacturing unit coming up in Tamil Nadu

Chinese company Huawei Telecommunications is establishing a telecom equipment manufacturing facility in Tamil Nadu, with an investment of around Rs 22 billion (\$500 million).

Freescal hosts smart car race in India

Freescal Semiconductor India, in collaboration with the Center for Electronic Design and Technology (CEDT) and the Indian Institute of Science (IISc), recently hosted the final of the 'Smart Car Race India 2010'—a first-of-its-kind competition for engineering students in India. Approximately 290 engineering students, along with their faculty guides, participated in the competition.

During the competition, students assembled an intelligent model racing car that automatically recognised the specially designed racing track at the final competition venue. Freescal provided the model car kit and the required development tools to develop a model racing car based on its microcontroller technology, along with mentoring support to the teams.

The participating teams were judged by a panel of experts from the automotive industry, embedded systems domain and academia. The criteria included speed, design and technology. The team whose car completed the race with the best performance was declared the winner.